

Aida Camacho Ponce de Leon

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Languages: Spanish (Native) | English (Fluent) | Chinese (Conversational)

EDUCATION

Dual Degree — Duke Kunshan University & Duke University

Bachelor of Arts in Computation and Design

Track: Social Policy | Concentration: Environmental Sustainability

May 2026 | GPA: 3.812/4.00 | Cum Laude

Honors & Awards

- Cum Laude
- Dean's List, Spring 2023
- Dean's List with Distinction, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Spring 2026

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Senior Thesis — Household Energy Consumption and Energy Burden in Mexico

Duke Kunshan University | Advisor: Prof. Zuchuan Li, Ph.D.

Aug 2025 – May 2026

- Conducted an applied research project examining household electricity consumption, energy demand, and energy burden in Mexico.
- Cleaned, merged, transformed, and analyzed large-scale socioeconomic, demographic, housing, appliance, and energy datasets.
- Applied statistical and machine learning methods to identify factors associated with household electricity consumption and energy affordability.
- Developed predictive models to examine variation in residential electricity demand across households.
- Conducted geospatial analysis to investigate spatial patterns in energy consumption and household energy burden.
- Created data visualizations and quantitative analyses to communicate findings and identify potential implications for energy-efficiency and affordability interventions.

Bass Connections Student Researcher

Duke Kunshan University / Duke University — Nicholas School of the Environment

Faculty Leaders: Prof. Yanran Yang, Ph.D. & Prof. Dalia Patino-Echeverri, Ph.D.

Aug 2024 – June 2025

- Conducted interdisciplinary research on the integration of nuclear district heating into regional energy markets in China and the United States.

- Collected, cleaned, integrated, and synthesized economic, environmental, energy, and social datasets from multiple sources.
- Developed cost-benefit analyses to assess the economic feasibility of nuclear district heating systems.
- Conducted market and policy analyses to identify economic, technological, and regulatory constraints affecting implementation.
- Applied quantitative and statistical methods to evaluate complex energy-system data and support evidence-based conclusions.
- Collaborated with faculty and students across energy systems, environmental policy, economics, and data analytics.
- Synthesized technical research findings for interdisciplinary discussions and project deliverables.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Spanish Teaching Assistant

Duke Kunshan University | Aug 2023 – May 2026

- Led small-group instructional sessions for beginner and intermediate Spanish learners.
- Developed targeted instructional strategies based on student performance and learning progress.
- Provided individualized feedback and supported students with different levels of prior language experience.
- Communicated complex concepts clearly in a collaborative classroom environment.

LEADERSHIP & UNIVERSITY EXPERIENCE

Orientation Leader

Duke Kunshan University | May 2023 – Nov 2023

- Guided incoming international students through university orientation and onboarding.
- Coordinated activities and communicated logistical information across a diverse multicultural student community.
- Supported students in navigating academic, social, and administrative aspects of university life.

Commencement Volunteer

Office of Student Affairs, Duke Kunshan University | Mar 2023 – May 2024

- Supported logistics and coordination for large-scale university commencement events.
- Communicated with students, faculty, staff, and international families in a fast-paced environment.

- Assisted with event operations and problem-solving under time constraints.

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Climate Change AI Summer School

Certificate of Attendance | 2024

- Completed interdisciplinary training on applications of artificial intelligence and machine learning to climate-related challenges.
- Explored applications of AI in agriculture, climate policy, and data-driven environmental decision-making.
- Examined approaches for applying machine learning to practical environmental and sustainability problems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Data Analysis:

Python · R · pandas · NumPy · scikit-learn · statsmodels

Statistical & Machine Learning:

Regression · Classification · Random Forest · Predictive Modeling · Statistical Modeling · Feature Engineering · Data Preprocessing · Exploratory Data Analysis

Data Visualization:

Matplotlib · Plotly · Data Visualization · Dashboard Development

Geospatial Analysis:

GIS · GeoPandas · QGIS · ArcGIS Pro · Spatial Analysis

Natural Language Processing:

NLTK · spaCy · TF-IDF · Text Preprocessing

Other:

Git · GitHub · Data Cleaning · Data Integration

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

Machine Learning for Social Science · Introduction to Data Science · Computational Social Science · Environmental Data Analytics · Applied Statistical Methods · Modeling and Predicting · Probability · Linear Algebra · GIS · Computation and Problem Solving